THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

2020W1 UBC Individual TA Report for ECON 101 L5C - Principles of Microeconomics (Bufang Duan)

Project Title: **2020W1 UBC TA Evaluations**

Course Audience: **48**
Responses Received: **17**
Response Ratio: **35%**

Report Comments

Recommended Minimum Response Rates

Class Size	Recommended Minimum Response Rates based on 80% confidence & ± 10% margin
< 10	75%
11 - 19	65%
20 - 34	55%
35 - 49	40%
50 - 74	35%
75 - 99	25%
100 - 149	20%
150 - 299	15%
300 - 499	10%
> 500	5%

Creation Date: **Sunday, September 12, 2021**

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TA Questions

Question	N	n	SD	D	N	A	SA	N/A	IM	DI
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	48	17	0	0	1	1	14	1	4.9	0.2
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	48	16	0	0	1	4	11	0	4.8	0.3
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	48	16	0	0	1	1	12	2	4.9	0.2
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	48	17	0	0	2	2	13	0	4.8	0.3
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	48	17	0	0	1	1	15	0	4.9	0.2
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	48	17	0	0	1	1	15	0	4.9	0.2
The TA presented information clearly.	48	17	0	0	3	3	11	0	4.7	0.4
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	48	17	0	0	2	2	13	0	4.8	0.3
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	48	17	0	0	1	1	14	1	4.9	0.2
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	48	17	0	0	1	1	15	0	4.9	0.2
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	48	17	0	0	2	0	7	8	4.9	0.3
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	48	17	0	0	2	2	12	1	4.8	0.3
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	48	17	0	0	2	0	8	7	4.9	0.3
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	48	16	0	0	1	2	13	0	4.9	0.2

Question	%Favourable
The TA was helpful when I requested course-related assistance.	94%
The TA was well-prepared for their duties.	94%
The TA was readily available to me either through office hours or by appointment.	93%
The TA communicated at an appropriate level for me.	88%
The TA exhibited interest in the subject matter.	94%
The TA showed knowledge of the subject matter.	94%
The TA presented information clearly.	82%
The TA was effective at stimulating interest in the subject matter.	88%
The TA was receptive to a variety of perspectives and ideas.	94%
The TA treated me and other students with equal respect.	94%
The TA's comments on my written work were helpful.	78%
The TA encouraged intelligent and independent thought.	88%
The TA's evaluation of my work was fair and reasonable.	80%
The TA made a very positive contribution to this course.	94%

How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very Good	N/A	IM	DI
48	17	0	0	1	1	15	0	4.9	0.2

Question	%Favourable
How would you rate the overall contribution of the TA to the course?	94%

Of the sessions in which the Teaching Assistant was involved, how often did you attend?

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Options	Count	Percentage
None	0	0%
Less than 25%	1	7%
25-50%	1	7%
51-75%	2	13%
Greater than 75%	11	73%

Which, if any, of the following did your Teaching Assistant do? (Please mark each element that is appropriate)

Options	Count
Led discussion-tutorial groups	16
Held office hours	14
marked examination(s)	2
marked essay(s)-assignment(s)	0
gave classroom lectures	1
conducted labs	1
responded to email	12
Respondent(s)	16

Considering everything, how would you rate this course?

N	n	Very poor	Poor	Neutral	Good	Very good	N/A	IM	DI
48	17	3	1	6	5	2	0	3.3	0.7

Question	%Favourable
Considering everything, how would you rate this course?	41%

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of your teaching assistant's (TA's) teaching, attitudes to students, class atmosphere, or any other matters affecting the quality of instruction that you consider worthy of note.

Comments
Thank you for carrying me in this course, especially in the beginning. Sometimes, I would be so lost after the synchronous lectures, but after attending the discussions, I would gain a better understanding of the concepts.
William has gone above and beyond for the care of the students. Without his empathy and insight into the course, I would be failing beyond means. He has been open to helping us at the moment and answers all questions. He is passionate about the course and it shows in his teaching method. William is a respected TA amongst peers and has played a major role in wanting the best for the students.
The tutorials were the most personal and interactive of any of my online classes.
Shows great enthusiasm and was very engaging.
very positive
Warm guy who is super nice, very open to questions, and way more than qualified to teach.
William was the type of guy that went not one, but fifty extra miles for us. Highly prepared for the session, open to students, and really put his personal time and commitment to helping and supporting us way beyond what he was required to.
William showed genuine interest in the students' learning and made sure to pause often between topics for the opportunity to ask questions. He always made sure that everyone understood before moving on.
William is AMAZING. He was so much more helpful than the prof himself, he was so clear on instructions and when teaching concepts. He prepared me so much better for midterms and the finals. Literally such a good TA. Very funny too!!
The TA made himself available to students regularly for extra help or office hours. He was good at communicating the material and explaining concepts in applicable ways. Made discussion sessions engaging by encouraging student participation.
William (Bufang) was an excellent TA. I could not recommend him highly enough. He made this class enjoyable for me. I have never laughed, smiled, and learned so much at the same time before. He always made time for students and held office hours way more often than was required of him. I would ask for this TA again if that was an option. My only criticism of this TA is that I would have appreciated if they were more up to date on the synchronous lecture material as this would have enabled them to better prepare us for the exams. However, when students told him what we learned during the synchronous lectures, he was quick to figure it out and explain it to us. This is just a testament of his deep understanding of the class material.

Please comment on any aspects, positive or negative, of the format and content of the course as they may have affected the teaching assistant's performance.

Comments
There is so much content in the course, making it difficult to grasp all of the content on a deep level. Despite this, you were still a great TA.
I feel like he did not know many details and because we always wanted questions answered, he, unfortunately, got stuck with a lot of inquiries. We are terribly sorry for putting that pressure on you.
The ta clearly knew every detail of the course material, but sometimes did not know what we had recently covered in class.
Sometimes it is unclear what we need to prepare for the exams (ex. none of us knew if we needed to know indifference and engel curves for midterm 1 so we were all cramming during the TA Q&A 2 hours before the actual exam)
Professors often did not know what was going on (especially around midterms) which may have caused stress for both the TA and students during some discussion sessions
Vaney should not be teaching this class, the TAs should.
The course was sort of a mess, but William handled it extremely well. He clarified issues for us and kept us informed.

Explanatory Note

Percent Favourable Rating

This is the percentage of respondents who rated the instructor a 4 or 5 (Agree or Strongly Agree).

Interpolated Median

The data collected for Student Evaluations of Teaching (SEoT) are ordinal in nature, with a natural order (from 1 to 5). While the mean may be used as a measure of central tendency for such data, it is not an appropriate or accurate representation of SEoT data (cf. Stark & Freishtat, 2014). The usual measure of central tendency for ordinal data is the median. As a result, we have been reporting the mean and the median for the last several years. After considerable thought and data modeling, we now believe that the interpolated median is the best representation of the data, since it takes the frequency distribution into account.

Consider the following example from 2015W, the two classes have identical mean (3.8). However, the instructor in class 2 received 77% favourable (4-5) ratings, compared to 53% for the instructor in class 1. The Interpolated median values of (3.7 and 4.2), much better reflects the distribution of the scores above and below their respective median. Furthermore, the interpolated median is better correlated with percent favourable rating; such that an interpolated median of 3.5 on a Likert scale of 1 to 5, corresponds to 50% favourable rating.

Frequency Distribution

Response for UMI	Class 1	Class 2
5 = Strongly agree	5	5
4 = Agree	3	5
3 = Neither agree nor disagree	6	0
2 = Disagree	1	2
1 = Strongly disagree	0	1
Mean	3.8	3.8
Median	4.0	4.0

Interpolated Median	3.7	4.2
Percent favourable rating	53%	77%

Dispersion Index

The dispersion Index is a measure of variability suitable for ordinal data (Rampichini, Grilli & Petrucci 2004). This dispersion index has values between zero and 1. A zero dispersion index indicates that all students in the section gave the same rating to the instructor. An index value of 1.0 is obtained when the class splits evenly between the two extreme values (Strongly Disagree & Strongly Agree), a very rare occurrence. In SEoT data at UBC, the index rarely exceeds 0.85, and mostly for evaluations not meeting the minimum recommended response rate.